



Limitithron's

— GUIDE to — NAVAL COMBAT

Compatible with
5th Edition

RULES SUPPLEMENT



LIMITHRON'S GUIDE TO NAVAL COMBAT



Credits

Designed and Illustrated by: Luke Stratton | Limithron

For more maps, adventures, printable ship reference cards, and tokens visit:

www.limithron.com

On the Cover & Page 10: *The Battle of Trafalgar* by William Clarkson Stanfield, 1836, Public Domain (PD-US-expired), Courtesy of Wikimedia.org.

Editing and Proofreading By:

Tyler Stratton, Allan Sugarbaker

Playtesting and Feedback Provided By:

Tyler "Blackwood" Stratton, Scott "Tezomoc" Sesko, Ryan "La Chance" Zanger, Kevin "The Alderman" Campbell, Tad Edwards, Drakon Vines, Morrie, The_Nak (Sailing Official Discord), Ethan (Sailing Official Discord)

Battle Royale Playtesters:

Tyko, Need4SleepCarbon, Bilge Goblin, Trickster, Banished_Jelly, Oshy

The following sources have provided inspiration:

Little, Benerson. *The Sea Rover's Practice*. 2005.
Lambert, Andrew. *War at Sea in the Age of Sail*. 2000.
Assassin's Creed IV: Black Flag, Ubisoft, 2013.
Sid Meier's Pirates!, Firaxis Games/Atari, 2004.
Tuñez, Mike. *Oak & Iron*, Firelock Games, 2020.
Pirates of the Spanish Main, WizKids, Inc. 2004.

Second Printing. v3.3

Foreword

This supplement is intended as a jumping off point for making ship to ship combat in 5e fun, exciting, fast, and most of all *engaging*. No ones want to sit around while only one player commands the ship, but at the same time getting bogged down in sailing rules can be cumbersome and boring. Spellcasters should be able to affect the outcome of naval encounters, but the barbarian shouldn't be able to sink a ship with their axe without a *lot* of effort. If the bard wants to swing across to the enemy ship and launch a full-on assault on the enemy captain's feelings, well, then I think he "can certainly try".

After years of playing pirate miniature games and video games, and several more years running my own RPG campaign, *Tales from the Caribbean*, I think I've finally cracked the code. With ships, it's really easy to be too complicated. Too many dice, too many ship stats and hit points, too many rules about wind and speed, complicated boarding rules... no thank you! The ships in this guide aren't any more complicated than skeletons. Well, enormous skeletons with 100 passengers, movement that depends on the wind, and attacks that deal over 80 damage a turn. But, yeah, skeletons.

So let your players blow stuff up and steal some booty. Let them capture five huge ships and learn first hand why that's a bad idea. Make them fear for their lives by chasing them with overpowered pirate hunting vessels, krakens, and dragon turtles. Create your own enchanted Man of War with wings for sails and fire breath attacks. *You are the captain now*.

Yo, ho, ho and happy sailing,

Luke Stratton | Limithron

November 2022

Contents

NAVAL COMBAT RULES	3
HEX WATER MAP	8
APPENDIX A: SHIPS	13
APPENDIX B: AMMUNITION	14
APPENDIX C: ENCOUNTERS	15
SAMPLE SHIP CARDS	14

Open Game License v1.0a Copyright 2000, Wizards of the Coast, LLC. System Reference Document 5.1 Copyright 2016, Wizards of the Coast, Inc.; Authors Mike Mearls, Jeremy Crawford, Chris Perkins, Rodney Thompson, Peter Lee, James Wyatt, Robert J. Schwalb, Bruce R. Cordell, Chris Sims, and Steve Townshend, based on original material by E. Gary Gygax and Dave Arneson.



PATREON *Limithron*

Introduction

This supplement is designed to provide an easy-to-learn, adaptable rules set for ship-to-ship combat in 5th edition of the world's most popular roleplaying game. While these rules and ship stats are designed with gunpowder and cannons in mind, they can easily be adapted to any fantasy setting by reskinning or modifying attacks.

THE BASICS

- Ships are based on monster stat blocks. They have their own CR number to aid the GM in balancing encounters.
- For simplicity and ease of play, hit points and damage are scaled down from melee combat by a factor of 1:5.
- Combat happens on a hex grid (1 hex = 50ft), or you can play with simple rulers.
- There are simple, optional rules for wind.
- Ships *may* rotate or turn, and typically they *must* move at least 1 space.
- Initiative is rolled **each round**, but only ships and solo creatures roll. Passengers act on their ship's initiative.
- Each ship has a **captain**. That captain assigns **Action Points** for their ship at the top of each round.
- Most actions require the ship to make an ability or skill check; characters can choose **Action Stations** on their turn to help with these checks.
- Customizing ships is easy and fun!

Ship Statistics

Ship statistics are adapted from 5e monsters, but they have been mutated to be more applicable for inanimate vehicles. Stats are used to represent various aspects of a ship, like overall physical construction (Constitution) or the crew's skill (Charisma).

Strength. The potency of a ship's attacks. This could represent the size of its siege weapons or the precise aim of a well trained crew. *Uses: damage roll modifier.*

Dexterity. The maneuverability of a ship. Smaller ships are more dexterous.

Uses: initiative modifier, the "Coming About" ship action.

Constitution. Construction quality and fortitude of a ship. *Uses: hit point calculation.*

Charisma. Represents the quality of the crew and their leadership. Henceforth referred to as **Skill**.

Uses: To Hit, "Full Sail" action, "Repair" action.

AC. How hard a ship is to hit. Represents the resilience of the ship's hull or its small size and agility.

Speed. The number of 50ft spaces the ship can move a turn with favorable winds. Also the maximum number of 50 mile spaces a ship can travel a day at a normal travel speed. See the section on "Wind & Movement".

Hit Points and Formula. The amount of damage a ship can take before it is **Derelict**. This number is scaled down by a factor 1:5 when compared to creature-scale encounters. See the section on "Dice and Scaling".

Crew. The minimum number of crew needed to operate the ship without being **Stressed**. Crew numbers are not tracked for the purposes of ship combat but can be used for boarding, mob combat, and roleplaying.

Max Crew. The maximum number of crew and passengers this ship can carry comfortably on long voyages. Most ships can carry *double* this number on short voyages such as raids or refugee operations.

Cargo. The number of cargo "slots" the ship has, ranging from 0-6. The size and value of cargo is up to the GM. Cargo might have different value in different ports.

SIZE

Ships have their own scale separate from creatures.

Uses: hit point calculation, ramming.

SHIP SIZES

Size	Space	Hit Die	Hexes	Example
Tiny	<30ft	d4	1	Dingy, Canoe
Small	<50ft	d6	1	Longboat
Medium	<75	d8	1	Sloop
Large	<100ft	d10	1x3	Brigantine
Huge	<125ft	d12	1x3	Galley
Gargantuan	>125ft	d20	3x5	Ship of the Line

Dice & Scaling

The damage rolls and hit points in this supplement are **scaled by a factor of 1:5** when compared to creature scale combat. For example, a ship that has 10 HP and deals 1d6 damage would have 50 HP if attacked by a creature, and it would deal 1d6 x 5 damage. Any damage dealt to ships by creatures should be rounded down to the nearest 5, or you can track exact ship hit points by multiplying their base value by five. A *fireball* spell could hypothetically sink a rowboat or canoe in one shot, but a 1st Rate Ship of the Line could have 1,000 HP if attacked with a cutlass!

Skill & Ability Test Difficulty

The default difficulty for skill and ability checks during ship combat is **DC12**. Checks are rolled by the acting captain unless another character is at a corresponding Action Station. The GM can **modify the DC based on conditions** like rough seas, weather, surprise, terrain, or a crew that is inexperienced, wounded, or frightened.



Movement & Position

Ship combat is typically played on a 1" hex grid where **each hex represents 50 feet** from center to center. Most ships will take up 1 to 3 hexes. They should be orientated with the center of the ship on the center of a hex with the bow and stern crossing perpendicular edges. Generally, a ship's bow will only face one of 6 different hex directions, though the GM may allow "half-turns" in certain instances like boarding or navigating terrain. All turns are 60 degree rotations (one hex face) from the center of the ship. If you prefer to play without a hex grid, you can make cardboard rulers to measure 60° angles and 1" distances.

MOVING A SHIP

- ⚔ A ship **may** move up to its full movement each turn after adjusting for the wind.
- ⚔ All ships **must move at least 1"** (exceptions: *In Irons*, *Anchored*)
- ⚔ A ship must move **directly forward** to the hex in front of its bow.
- ⚔ A ship may **rotate twice** (rotate one hex face or 60°) at any point before, during, or after its movement, but **no ship may turn more than once per hex**.
- ⚔ Ships that are *In Irons* may not move forward but may still rotate once.
- ⚔ Ships that are *Anchored* cannot move or turn.

Wind & Movement

The wind direction is an important part of sailing. Some groups might find using rules for wind cumbersome, while others might find a thrill in the extra element of strategy it can add, especially when a spellcaster may be able to alter conditions. Use the following optional rules if you want to use wind in your encounters.

WIND DIRECTION

d6	Flat Top Hexes	Pointy Top Hexes
1	North	Northeast
2	Northeast	East
3	Southeast	Southeast
4	South	Southwest
5	Southwest	West
6	Northwest	Northwest

POINTS OF SAIL

Ship sailing speeds depend on the angle of the wind. A ship's **point of sail** is determined at the **start of its turn** and does not change during its turn. If a ship starts its turn *With the Wind* and then turns *Close to the Wind*, it still gets its full movement that turn.

POINTS OF SAIL

Point of Sail	Ship Speed
<i>With The Wind</i>	Full speed.
<i>Close To The Wind</i>	Half speed, rounded down (min. 1").
<i>In Irons</i>	Speed 0" (can still rotate once).
<i>Anchored</i>	Speed 0" and cannot turn.



Example: If the wind is coming from 1 (North), this ship is **In Irons** and cannot move (but may still turn once). If the wind is coming from 2 or 6, it is sailing **Close To The Wind** and may only move half of its normal speed; at 3, 4, and 5 it would be **With The Wind** and can move its full movement.

ANCHORING A SHIP

A ship that is **Anchored** cannot move or turn, and has a max speed of 0. In an emergency the crew can **Cut and Run**.

Drop Anchor. Cost: All of a ship's action points.

The crew lowers the anchor(s) and the ship's speed is reduced to 0.

Weighing Anchor. Cost: All of a ship's action points.

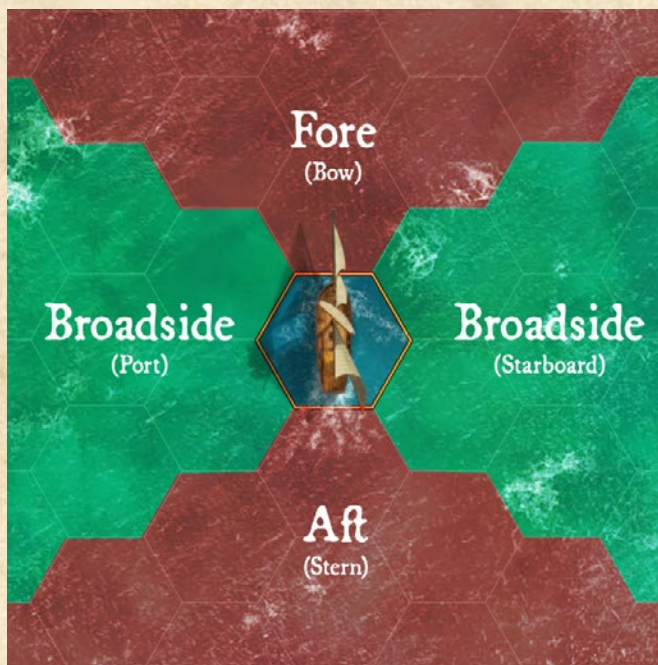
The crew raises the ship's anchor(s). The ship's max speed is reduced to half for this turn.

Cut and Run. Cost: Zero action points.

The ship is no longer anchored, but will drift until new anchors are acquired! The ship's max speed is reduced to half for this turn.



Arc of Fire



In the age of gunpowder weapons, most ships carried the majority of their arsenal along the sides of the ship, referred to as **Broadside**. Vessels needed to maneuver to port or starboard in order for most cannons to have a shot at a target they were attacking. Some other attacks, like the 1st Rate's *Chase Guns*, can only fire **Fore & Aft**.

The Order of Combat

Like creature scale combat, ship combat is organized into turns and rounds. Initiative is rolled for each ship, and the creatures on that ship all act on their ship's turn. Independent creatures like sea monsters or characters that are not on a ship roll their own initiative.

Sailing is slow, and weapons take time to reload, but these rules are designed to be fast and fun. For the purposes of rules and action economy, **a round of combat represents 6 seconds** in the game world, though 30 seconds to 1 minute is a more thematic representation.

COMBAT ROUND STEP BY STEP

1. **Captain Phase.** Captains choose their ship's actions by spending *Action Points*, and they may roll to *Push the Crew*.
2. **Declare Lookout & Bosuns.** Any PCs may declare these stations now. Bosuns may try to *Raise Morale*.
3. **Roll Initiative.** Lookouts and/or captains all roll initiative, then apply lookout & bosun modifiers.
4. **Take turns.** Each ship takes a turn in initiative order. On a ship's turn, characters may take actions in any order they see fit. Each may claim an Action Station based on the captain's chosen action points, and they may choose a

different station each turn. They may also choose another action like casting a spell. Ships and characters may *Ready* actions and trigger then any time before the ship's next turn, similar to the *Ready* action in creature scale combat.

5. **Begin the next round.** Repeat the steps until naval combat is over. This could be when boarding and switching to creature scale combat, or when all ships from one side are derelict.

CAPTAIN'S PHASE

During this phase, each ship's captain decides what actions the ship will take. Each ship has a set number of *Action Points* and the captain can spend any of these to assign actions for the characters and crew on board to carry out later in the turn. Any actions not carried out by the other characters will be rolled by the captain. The captain may also roll to push the Crew (see the section on the Captain Action Station).

INITIATIVE PHASE

Initiative is **rerolled each round of combat**. After all captains have decided their ships' actions for the turn, each ship rolls a d20 and adds its DEX modifier. This roll is made by the captain unless the ship has a lookout. See the section on "Action Stations".

A SHIP'S TURN

On a ship's turn, the pilot or captain may **move a distance up to the ship's speed** and make **two rotations**. The characters **may take any actions that the captain spent action points on** at the beginning of the round, plus any other actions or bonus actions like the bosun's *Raise Morale* ability or casting a spell. After the characters have gone, the captain rolls for any actions the characters didn't complete. These actions may be taken before, after, or at any point along the ship's movement.

Characters may also *Ready* actions (i.e. wait for a target to be in range.) If the ship readies any Attack actions, it may make all of its attacks when the Ready action is triggered, not just one attack (as opposed to creature scale combat). Action Point actions are *optional* and the characters and crew do not have to take those actions unless they or the captain want to, but the ship may not change what actions are available until the beginning of the next round.

BOARDING & CLOSE COMBAT

After ships are close enough to engage in close combat or creature scale combat, GMs are encouraged to switch to 5ft/square battle maps or "theater of the mind". Mass combat and mob combat rules can be used to deal with the crew, but, like any good story, it's the **heroes and not the NPCs & background characters** that matter!

RAMMING AND COLLISIONS

Ramming

At the beginning of the turn, a captain may spend all of a ship's Action Points to declare a ram. On that ship's turn, if it **ends its movement with any of its forward three sides touching another ship** it rams. Both ships roll their base hit die and add +1 to their roll for each space traveled since the beginning of its last turn. Deal that much damage to the other ship. In addition, **each ship that was part of a Ram since the start of its last turn is considered to be Anchored (speed 0, can't turn) for 1 turn.**

If for some reason the ramming ship cannot get to a space adjacent to another ship, it does not ram and its Action Points are lost.

Another test for whether a ship can ram is this: if the hex directly in front of the ramming ship overlaps with another ship's hex or the hex in front of or behind the target ship then the ship can ram.

Example. A brigantine (7d10+14 hp) rams into a sloop (6d8+6 hp). The brigantine travels 3 spaces before making contact, so it will deal 1d10+3 damage to the sloop. The sloop moved 5 spaces on its last turn, so it will deal 1d8+5 damage to the brigantine. Both ships are considered **Anchored** for their next turn.

Collisions

If a ship collides with something (shoals, a large rock or island, another ship unintentionally) it will **take** damage equal to one of its hit dice plus the distance it traveled since the start of its last turn. In addition, each ship that was part of a collision since the start of its last turn is considered to be **Anchored** for 1 turn. The GM may also deal damage to the object the ship collided with, and might impose other effects like the ship being stuck until a **Repair** action is taken.

Character Actions

Each turn, a character may **spend their action** to claim an **Action Station** (PCs still get a bonus action, free action, and reaction). Choosing a station is **optional** and they may be chosen again each round. Any actions that are not covered by a PC are rolled for by the captain using the ship's stats (but without any Sailing Dice).

SAILING DICE

Most Action Stations allow each character to add a d4 **Sailing Die** to one of the ship's checks.

ACTION STATIONS

CAPTAIN

Limit 1/ship, required

Each ship **must** have an assigned captain. If a ship doesn't have a PC captain the GM can let one act as captain. At the beginning of the round, the captain **chooses actions for each of the ship's action points**. Captains that choose the attack action only need to decide how many points to allocate when choosing the action. The attacks used and their targets may be chosen on the ship's turn.

Push the Crew. During a time of need the captain may to push the crew to their limits. As a bonus action, the captain may attempt an Intimidation or Persuasion check. On a success, the ship gains one extra action point this turn but loses one action point next turn. A captain may not attempt to push the crew two turns in a row.

PILOT

Limit 1 PC/ship

The pilot moves the ship's token, and makes the roll if the ship is attempting to **Come About** using the ship's **DEX** and adding their Sailing Die. The pilot also makes any checks required to navigate terrain or obstacles.

LOOKOUT

Limit 1 PC/ship

Before initiative is rolled each round, any PC may spend their action to become the lookout. The lookouts **roll initiative** for the ship, and **add or subtract** their Sailing Die from the result. Ships with lookouts get **+1 AC**.

BOSUN

Limit 1 PC/ship

This station may be claimed at any time, including before initiative has been rolled.

Raise Morale. As a bonus action, the bosun may make an *Intimidation* or *Persuasion* skill check to choose one of the following: give all of the ship's attack rolls and skill check rolls +1 this turn, **or** temporarily remove the **Stressed** condition from the ship for one turn (that ship that may still take the *Repair* action).

GUNNER

Limit 1 PC per ship's attack

The gunners choose weapons and targets and roll any attacks using the ship's **Skill**, adding their Sailing Die to their **first** attack roll. If there is more than one gunner, they take turns rolling attacks until there are no attacks left.

CARPENTER

No Limit

The carpenter rolls to **Repair** the ship using the ship's **Skill** (at disadvantage due to the **Stressed** condition), and





Galley

Huge Ship

DEX

-6

Speed

4

Skill

+6

AC

15

HP

115

11d12+44

Current

Crew

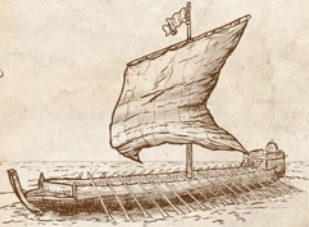
80

160 max

Current

Cargo

3



Oars This ship may spend half of its action points (rounded down) to travel 2 additional spaces in any direction (not affected by wind).

Actions (5 points/turn)

Ballista 1pt, 3"/6", 2d6+5

Mangonel 2pts, 6"/12", 2d4+5

Naval Ram Deals double damage when ramming, and has resistance against damage taken on turns it has taken the Ram action.

Repair 5pts, Skill Test: recover 2d6+5 hp

Come About 1pt, DEX Test: 1 extra rotation

Full Sail 2pts, Skill Test: Speed +1



Ship of Bone

Large Ship

DEX

-3

Speed

5

Skill

+6

AC

15

HP

68

8d10+24

Current

Crew

24

48 max

Current

Cargo

4



Undead Fortitude If reduced to 0 hit points, make a CON saving throw (+3, DC of 5 + the damage taken), unless the damage is radiant or from a critical hit. On a success, the Ship of Bone drops to 1 hit point instead.

Actions (4 points/turn)

Cannons 1pt, broadside 6"/12", 1d10+3

Small Arms 2pts, 3"/6", 1d8+3

Repair 4pts, Skill Test: recover 1d10+3 hp

Come About 2pts, DEX Test: 1 extra rotation

Full Sail 2pts, Skill Test: Speed +1



Galleon from the Deep

Huge Ship

DEX

-5

Speed

4

Skill

+6

AC

16

HP

104

12d12+48

Current

Crew

70

150 max

Current

Cargo

6



Down To The Locker! While submerged, this ship cannot attack or be attacked, is not affected by the wind, and has a max speed of 3. This ship's crew can breathe underwater.

Actions (5 points/turn)

Submerge/Surface 5pts

Claws/Tentacles 1pts, 1", 4d4+4

Cannons 1pt, broadside 6"/12", 1d10+4

Small Arms 2pts, 3"/6", 1d8+4

Repair 5pts, Skill Test: recover 1d10+4 hp

Come About 3pts, DEX Test: 1 extra rotation

Full Sail 2pts, Skill Test: Speed +1



Fort

Gargantuan Fortification

DEX

-

Speed

0

Skill

+5

AC

14

HP

135

10d20+30

Current

Crew

30

Current

Cargo

6



Heavy Armor Resistance against attacks that deal 10 damage or less.

Fortification Cannot move or ram, and has half as many action points when Stressed.

Actions (2 points/turn)

Cannons 1pt, 8"/16", 3d6+1

Repair 2pts, Skill Test: recover 1d6+1 hp



Stronghold

Gargantuan Fortification

DEX

-

Speed

0

Skill

+7

AC

15

HP

174

12d20+48

Current

Crew

40

Current

Cargo

8



Heavy Armor Resistance against attacks that deal 10 damage or less.

Fortification Cannot move or ram, and has half as many action points when Stressed.

Actions (3 points/turn)

Cannons 1pt, 8"/16", 3d6+3

Repair 2pts, Skill Test: recover 1d6+3 hp



Fortress

Gargantuan Fortification

DEX

-

Speed

0

Skill

+8

AC

16

HP

217

14d20+70

Current

Crew

50

Current

Cargo

10



Heavy Armor Resistance against attacks that deal 10 damage or less.

Fortification Cannot move or ram, and has half as many action points when Stressed.

Actions (4 points/turn)

Cannons 1pt, 8"/16", 3d6+4

Repair 2pts, Skill Test: recover 1d6+4 hp



Ghost Ship

Condition

DEX

-2

Speed

-2

Skill

-2

AC

-2

HP

-2

Crew

-50%

Cargo



Haunted by Night During the day this ship exists on the Ethereal plane. At night, once per hour the pilot may shift it to or from the Material plane. At dawn it automatically shifts back to the Ethereal plane.

Winds of Hades -2 to max speed. The wind does not affect this ship's movement.

Crew of The Damned This ship requires half the normally minimum crew, but if any crew leave the ship they will fade from existence after one hour and reappear aboard the ship at the next sunset.



Ship of Bone

Condition

DEX

-

Speed

-

Skill

-

AC

-

HP

-

Crew

-

Cargo



Undead Fortitude If reduced to 0 hit points, make a Skill Check (DC of 5 + the damage taken), unless the damage is radiant or from a critical hit. On a success, the Ship of Bone drops to 1 hit point instead.

Macabre Presence Each ship within 12" of this ship must make a Skill check (DC = 10 + this ship's Skill) or have disadvantage on attacks and skill checks for 6 rounds. If the check fails by 5 or more, the target cannot attack the Ship of Bone. The affected ship can repeat the check at the end of each of its turns, ending the effect on itself on a success.



DEX

-

Speed

-

Skill

-

AC

-

HP

-

Crew

-

Cargo









Round Shot



Range As listed.

Critical Hit Critical hits function as normal: roll damage dice twice.

Exploding Critical Hit Optional. When damage dice are rolled, any dice that roll the maximum value are rolled again, adding their value to the total. Repeat until no maximum values are rolled.



Chain Shot

Upgrade



Range 3"/6"

Target Masts & Rigging Attacks made with Chain Shot deal half damage, rounded down. Any ship that has taken damage from Chain Shot moves at half speed (rounded down, minimum of 1) until the end of its next turn.

Critical Hit When a Chain Shot attack scores a critical hit, the target ship's speed is 0 until the end of its next turn.



Grapeshot

Upgrade



Range 3"/6"

Target Crew Attacks made with Grapeshot deal half damage rounded down. Any ship that has taken any damage from Grapeshot has disadvantage on **Skill** checks and has -1 action point (minimum of 1) until the end of its next turn.

Critical Hit When a Grapeshot attack scores a critical hit, the target ship loses half of its action points (rounded down to a minimum of 1) until the end of its next turn.



Sloop

Medium Ship



DEX
+0

Speed
6
100ft

Skill
+3

AC
12

HP
33
6d8+6

Current

Crew
3
9 max

Current

Cargo
2

Weatherly This ship does not decrease its speed when sailing Close to the Wind.

Actions (2 points/turn)

Cannons 1pt, broadside 6"/12", 1d8+2
Small Arms 2pts, 3"/6", 1d6+2
Repair 2pts, **Skill Test**: recover 1d8+2 hp
Come About 1pts, **DEX Test**: 1 extra rotation
Full Sail 2pts, **Skill Test**: Speed +1



Brigantine

Large Ship



DEX
-2

Speed
5
250ft

Skill
+3

AC
13

HP
52
7d10+14

Current

Crew
15
30 max

Current

Cargo
3

Actions (2 points/turn)

Cannons 1pt, broadside 6"/12", 1d10+3
Small Arms 2pts, 3"/6", 1d8+3
Repair 2pts, **Skill Test**: recover 1d10+3 hp
Come About 2pts, **DEX Test**: 1 extra rotation
Full Sail 2pts, **Skill Test**: Speed +1



Frigate

Large Ship



DEX
-2

Speed
5
250ft

Skill
+4

AC
14

HP
60
8d10+16

Current

Crew
24
48 max

Current

Cargo
4

Actions (3 points/turn)

Cannons 1pt, broadside 6"/12", 1d10+2
Small Arms 2pts, 3"/6", 1d8+2
Repair 3pts, **Skill Test**: recover 1d10+2 hp
Come About 2pts, **DEX Test**: 1 extra rotation
Full Sail 2pts, **Skill Test**: Speed +1



6th Rate Man of War

Large Ship



DEX
-3

Speed
5
250ft

Skill
+5

AC
14

HP
76
9d10+27

Current

Crew
24
48 max

Current

Cargo
4

Actions (4 points/turn)

Cannons 1pt, broadside 6"/12", 1d10+2
Small Arms 2pts, 3"/6", 1d8+2
Repair 4pts, **Skill Test**: recover 1d10+2 hp
Come About 2pts, **DEX Test**: 1 extra rotation
Full Sail 2pts, **Skill Test**: Speed +1



5th Rate Man of War

Large Ship



DEX
-3

Speed
5
250ft

Skill
+6

AC
15

HP
85
10d10+30

Current

Crew
24
48 max

Current

Cargo
4

Actions (4 points/turn)

Cannons 1pt, broadside 6"/12", 1d10+3
Small Arms 2pts, 3"/6", 1d8+3
Repair 4pts, **Skill Test**: recover 1d10+3 hp
Come About 2pts, **DEX Test**: 1 extra rotation
Full Sail 2pts, **Skill Test**: Speed +1



1st Rate Ship of the Line

Gargantuan Ship



DEX
-6

Speed
3
150ft

Skill
+7

AC
18

HP
186
12d20+60

Current

Crew
150
400 max

Current

Cargo
5

Heavy Armor Resistance against attacks that deal 10 damage or less.

Sluggish Rotates once (unless Coming About).

Actions (5 points/turn)

Cannons 1pt, broadside 6"/12", 2d6+5
Chase Guns 3pts, fore/aft 6"/12", on hit target's speed is -1 until end of its next turn.
Small Arms 2pts, 3"/6", 2d4+5
Repair 5pts, **Skill Test**: recover 2d6+5 hp
Come About 3pts, **DEX Test**: 1 extra rotation
Full Sail 2pts, **Skill Test**: Speed +1

SHIP ACTION SUMMARY

Action	AP Cost	Description	Action Station
Attack (Broadside)	1	Attack with primary attack at a target in the ship's Broadside arc. 6"/12" Range	Gunner
Attack (Fore/Aft)	2	Attack with secondary attack: roll one die rank lower (ie. d4 instead of d6, d6 instead of d8, etc.). 3"/6" Range, any direction.	Gunner
Repair	All	Skill Test: Recover hit points equal to primary attack damage or remove the Derelict condition. May only be taken when Stressed .	Carpenter
Full Sail	2	Skill Test: Move one extra space this turn.	Rigger
Come About	*	DEX Test: One extra rotation this turn. Cost is ship dependent (default 2).	Pilot
Ram	All	Ram if touching another ship. Both ships deal damage equal to 1 hit die plus distance traveled and are considered Anchored next turn.	-
Drop Anchor	All	Speed 0 and Anchored .	-
Weigh Anchor	All	Speed 1/2 and no longer Anchored .	-
Cut and Run	0	Speed 1/2, no longer Anchored , but will drift when stopped.	-
Change Ammo Type	0	Change ammo (round shot, chain shot, grape shot, etc.) See <i>Appendix B</i> .	-

adds their Sailing Die to the result. If there are multiple carpenters, only one makes the skill roll but each adds their Sailing Die to the total.

RIGGER

No Limit

The rigger rolls to go **Full Sail** using the ship's skill, adding their Sailing Die to the result. If there are multiple riggers, choose one to make the roll, but each may add their Sailing Die to the total.

OTHER ACTIONS

Characters may take other actions like casting a spell, attacking another creature, swinging from the rigging, diving from a ship, hiding, etc.

Leveling Up Sailing Abilities

While characters can choose any action station, it can be fun to have characters "level up" and gain experience at certain stations. Here are some ideas:

- ☠ Increase the value of a Sailing Die (d6, d8, etc.)
- ☠ Adding modifiers to Sailing Dice (+1, +2, a PCs Proficiency modifier).
- ☠ Exploding Sailing Dice: if the max value of a die is rolled, reroll and add again.
- ☠ Giving advantage to Sailing Die rolls when at certain action stations.
- ☠ Covering two action stations at once.
- ☠ Increasing gunners' damage or "to hit" modifier.
- ☠ Giving the bosun a larger bonus when raising morale.
- ☠ Letting the lookout choose between rolling for initiative with advantage or disadvantage.
- ☠ Giving an experienced captain a Sailing Die that they can include with another character's skill check.

New Conditions

STRESSED

A ship is *Stressed* when it has **less than half** of its hit point maximum. A ship is also stressed if it has less than the required minimum crew. A stressed ship has **disadvantage on all attack rolls and skill checks**. Only stressed ships may take the *Repair* action. The bosun action station can take the *Raise Morale* action to attempt to temporarily remove this condition (and the ship may still take the *Repair* action if it is still under half its hit point maximum).

DERELICT

A ship is considered *Derelict* when it has 0 hit points. Its speed is reduced to zero, it cannot rotate, and it may only spend its Action Points on the **Repair** action.

Drifting. The GM may choose to have a derelict ship drift one space each turn, depending on weather conditions.

Sinking. Every time a derelict ship takes *additional* damage, it must make a *Sinking* saving throw. Roll a d20. If the roll is 10 or higher, the ship does not sink. Otherwise it fails and the ship sinks into the water. If a derelict ship is hit with a critical hit, it immediately fails its sinking saving throw.

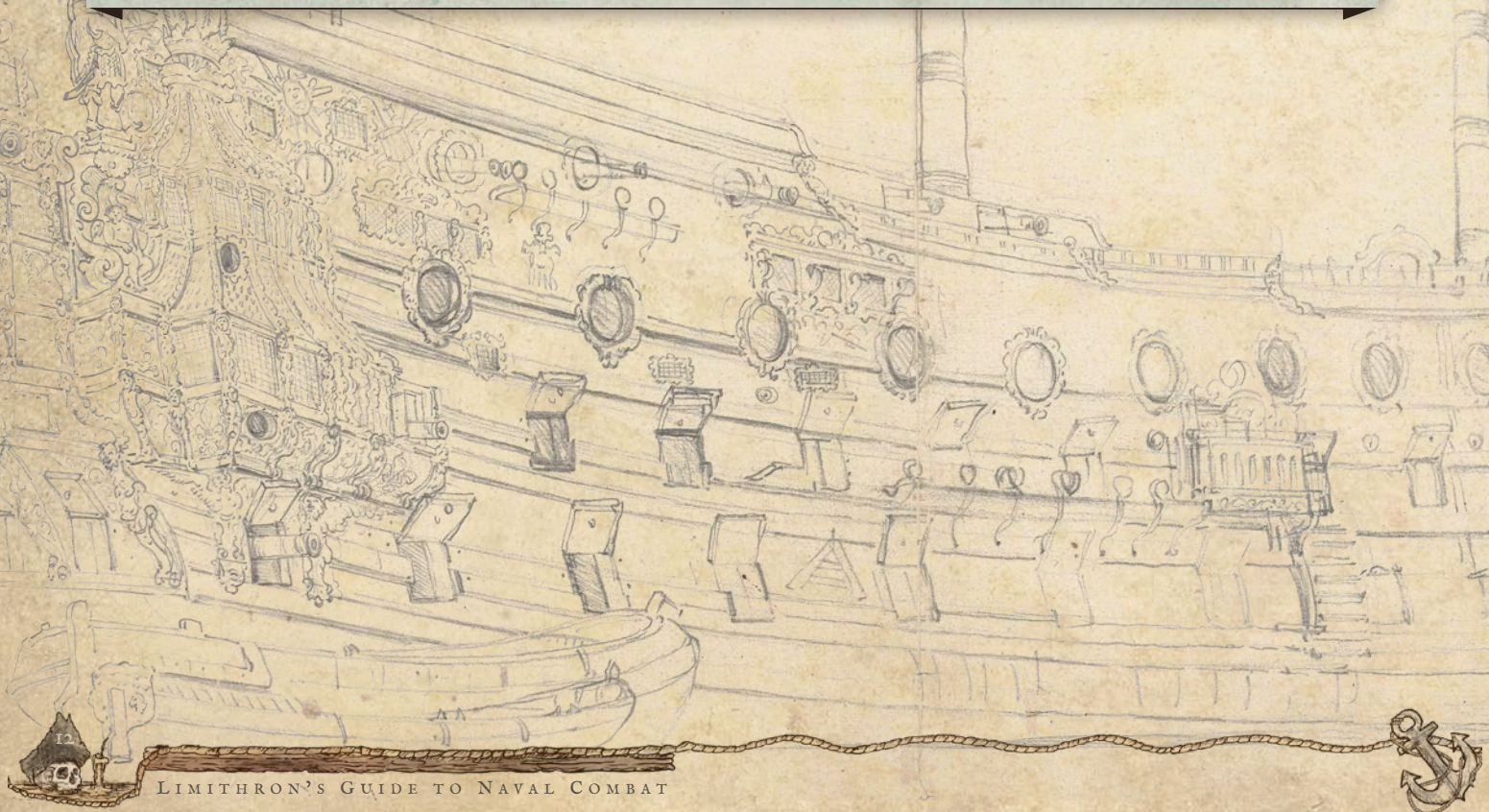
Repairing. The only action a derelict ship may take is **Repair**, which must be made at disadvantage. If the repair action is successful, the ship loses the derelict condition and regains 1 hit point (instead of the normal amount recovered by the repair action).

CUSTOMIZING SHIPS

The ships in this supplement are intended as a jumping off point. A tough warship might have more hit points. An old pirate sloop might be in need of repair and move very slow. Perhaps the characters have acquired a living ship that can cast a *gust of wind* spell several times a day. The sky's the limit.

You can give ships extra abilities just by borrowing them from existing monsters. Have a haunted ghost ship? How about adding a **Ghost's** *Etherealness* and *Horrifying Visage* to a ship's stat block. Is the flagship in the fleet issuing commands? Use the *Leadership* ability from a **Knight**. Here are some jumping off points:

- ☠ **Aggressive.** Upgraded cannons.
- ☠ **Breath Weapon.** Unique or upgraded ship weapons.
- ☠ **Damage Resistance.** Armor plating, flame resistant.
- ☠ **Damage Vulnerabilities.** Old, weak ships.
- ☠ **Elementals.** Magical wind, water, and fire ships.
- ☠ **Etherealness.** Ghost or Fey ships.
- ☠ **Feats.** Character feats like Lucky, Savage Attacker, or Inspiring Leader.
- ☠ **Flying Speed.** Steampunk airship, Hot Air Vessels.
- ☠ **Incorporeal Movement.** Ghost or Spirit ships.
- ☠ **Invisibility.** Fog bank ability or a mage on board.
- ☠ **Leadership.** Flagships, military vessels.
- ☠ **Legendary Resistance.** Tough, boss level ships.
- ☠ **Legendary Actions.** Ships with extra crew.
- ☠ **Magic Resistance.** Enchantments and protection runes.
- ☠ **Martial Advantage.** Well armed marines or buccaneers shoot muskets at close-by enemies.
- ☠ **Pack Tactics.** Fleets of canoes or small warships.
- ☠ **Parry.** Evasive maneuvers, skilled pilot.
- ☠ **Ram.** Battering ram: advantage on ram actions.
- ☠ **Reel.** Grappling hooks, magic tractor beams.
- ☠ **Regeneration.** Skilled carpenters.
- ☠ **Relentless.** Armor plating, reinforced hull.
- ☠ **Spellcasting.** Mage on board, living ships.
- ☠ **Swallow.** Mimic ships, sea monsters.
- ☠ **Teleport.** Magic or haunted ships, alien vessels.
- ☠ **Undead Fortitude.** Undead ships.



Appendix A: Ships Stats

Vessel	CR	Size	Speed	AC	HD	HP	STR	DEX	CON	To Hit	Base DMG	Abilities	Crew	Cargo	Action Points
Raft	1/8	Tiny	2	16	2	3	+2	+4	-1	+0	-		1/2	0	1
Canoe	1/4	Tiny	2	16	4	6	+2	+5	-1	+2	1d6+2	Oars	1/3	0	1
Rowboat	1/4	Tiny	2	16	4	6	+1	+5	-1	+2	1d4+1	Oars	1/3	0	1
Piragua	1/2	Small	3	15	5	17	+2	+2	+0	+3	2d4+2	Weatherly	2/4	0	1
Longboat	1/2	Small	3	15	5	17	+2	+2	+0	+3	2d4+2	Oars	2/4	0	1
Tartane	1	Med.	6	11	6	33	+2	+0	+1	+3	1d8+2	Weatherly	3/9	1	2
Ketch	1	Med.	6	11	6	33	+2	+0	+1	+3	1d8+2	Weatherly	3/9	1	2
Corvette	1	Med.	6	12	6	33	+2	+0	+1	+3	1d8+2	Weatherly	3/9	2	2
Sloop	1	Med.	6	12	6	33	+2	+0	+1	+3	1d8+2	Weatherly	3/9	2	2
Flute	2	Large	5	14	7	52	+3	-2	+2	+3	1d10+3		15/30	4	2
Brigantine	2	Large	5	13	7	52	+3	-2	+2	+3	1d10+3		15/30	3	2
East Indiaman	2	Large	5	13	7	52	+3	-2	+2	+3	1d10+3		15/30	5	2
Frigate	3	Large	5	14	8	60	+2	-2	+2	+4	1d10+2		24/48	4	3
Trade Galleon	3	Large	5	14	8	60	+2	-2	+2	+4	1d10+2		24/48	6	3
6th Rate Man o' War	4	Large	5	14	9	76	+2	-3	+3	+5	1d10+2		24/48	4	4
5th Rate Man o' War	5	Large	5	15	10	85	+3	-3	+3	+6	1d10+3		24/48	4	4
War Galleon	6	Huge	4	15	11	104	+3	-5	3	+6	1d10+3	Sluggish	50/100	6	4
4th Rate Ship of the Line	6	Huge	4	15	11	115	+3	-4	+4	+6	1d10+3	Sluggish	60/120	4	5
3rd Rate Ship of the Line	7	Huge	4	16	12	126	+4	-4	+4	+7	1d10+4	Sluggish	70/150	4	5
2nd Rate Ship of the Line	8	Carg.	3	17	12	174	+4	-5	+4	+7	1d12+4	Sluggish, Heavy Armor	100/300	5	5
1st Rate Ship of the Line	9	Carg.	3	18	12	186	+5	-6	+5	+7	2d6+5	Sluggish, Heavy Armor	150/400	5	5

Ship Abilities

Weatherly. This ship does not decrease its max speed when sailing Close to the Wind.

Oars. This ship may spend half of its action points (rounded down to a minimum 1) to travel 2 spaces in any direction. This is in addition to its normal movement and is not affected by wind.

Sluggish. This ship may only rotate once per turn (unless taking the Come About action).

Heavy Armor. This ship has Resistance against attacks that deal 10 damage or less.

Appendix B: Ammunition

Ships typically carry round shot (cannon balls), by default, but other types of ammo may be purchased from shipwrights. Additional ammunition ideas: canister shot, heated shot, spider shot, smoke bombs, poisonous canisters, random cargo (fork and knives), bones, and magical ammo.

ROUND SHOT

Round shot, or simply "cannon balls", are accurate and deadly at long range. They can cause massive damage against their targets and are used in all types of naval warfare, especially when the primary objective is sinking the enemy.

Range. As listed on ship card (typically 6"/12")

Critical Hit. Critical hits function as normal: roll damage dice twice.

Exploding Critical Hits. For an added level of chance and excitement, GMs may consider "exploding" critical hit damage dice to represent a ship taking extreme damage (ex. hitting the gunpowder magazine). When damage dice are rolled, any dice that roll the maximum value are rolled again, adding their value to the total. Repeat until no maximum values are rolled.



CHAIN SHOT

Chain shot is made by attaching two cannonballs—or two halves of a single cannonball—together with a chain. It is designed to attack a ship's masts and rigging and is typically used to slow ships down.

Range. 3"/6"

Target Masts & Rigging. Attacks made with Chain Shot deal half damage, rounded down. Any ship that has taken damage from Chain Shot moves at half speed (rounded down, minimum of 1) until the end of its next turn.

Critical Hit. When a Chain Shot attack scores a critical hit, the target ship's speed is 0 until the end of its next turn.



GRAPE SHOT

Grapeshot is made by filling a bag or hollow ball with small round metal balls, similar to shotgun shells. It is very effective against creatures but less so against a ship's hull.

Range. 3"/6"

Target Crew. Attacks made with Grapeshot deal half damage rounded down. Any ship that has taken any damage from Grape Shot has disadvantage on Skill checks and has -1 action point (minimum of 1) until the end of its next turn.

Critical Hit. When a Grapeshot attack scores a critical hit, the target ship loses half of its action points (rounded down to a minimum of 1) until the end of its next turn.



Appendix C: Encounters

SHIP CHALLENGE RATING RATIO TABLE

CR	1/4	1/2	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
1/4	1	3	5	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
1/2	1:2	1	2-3	4-6	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
1	1:4	1:2	1	2	4	6	-	-	-	-	-	-
2	1:8-1:12	1:4-1:6	1:2-1:3	1	1-2	2-3	3-5	4-6	-	-	-	-
3	1:12	1:6-1:10	1:3-1:8	1-1:2	1	1-2	2-3	2-4	3-5	4-6	5-6	6
4	1:12	1:7-1:10	1:4-1:8	1:2-1:3	1-1:2	1	1-2	2-3	2-4	3-5	3-6	5-6
5	-	-	1:8-1:12	1:3-1:5	1:2-1:3	1-1:2	1	1-2	1-2	2-3	2-3	2-4
6	-	-	1:8-1:12	1:4-1:7	1:2-1:5	1:2-1:3	1-1:2	1	1-2	2	2-3	2-3
7	-	-	1:12	1:5-1:9	1:3-1:6	1:2-1:4	1-1:2	1-1:2	1	1-2	1-2	1-3
8	-	-	-	1:7-1:9	1:4-1:6	1:3-1:4	1:2	1-1:2	1	1	1-2	1-2
9	-	-	-	1:8-1:9	1:5-1:6	1:3-1:4	1:2	1:2	1	1	1	1-2
10	-	-	-	1:9	1:6	1:4	1:2	1:2	1	1	1	1

Encounter Balancing

The above table can be used to quickly balance naval encounters, though it is intended as a very rough guide. For example, if the characters control a CR3 Frigate, 3 to 8 CR1 Sloops should be a balanced encounter mathematically, while a CR4 or higher vessel might outgun them. Note that ships with characters on board will undoubtedly have advantages—both strategically and statistically—when compared to NPC ships, and factors like positioning, wind, and ship condition can quickly swing the outcome of an encounter.

DEADLY NAVAL ENCOUNTERS

When running naval encounters, GMs are encouraged to keep in mind that a losing naval battle is much harder for characters to flee from than a typical creature scale encounter. Alternative to TPKs include:

- ☠ Surrender and capture.... and a jailbreak!
- ☠ Sinking the ship and having characters scramble to find floating debris (to then wash ashore, be rescued, or be swallowed by a dragon turtle).
- ☠ “Deus ex machina” style events like a ally's ship arriving to save the day, inclement weather moving in, or massive sea monsters attacking mid battle.



License

OPEN GAME LICENSE Version 1.0a

The following text is the property of Wizards of the Coast, Inc. and is Copyright 2000 Wizards of the Coast, Inc ("Wizards"). All Rights Reserved.

Definitions:

(a) "Contributors" means the copyright and/or trademark owners who have contributed Open Game Content;

(b) "Derivative Material" means copyrighted material including derivative works and translations (including into other computer languages), potation, modification, correction, addition, extension, upgrade, improvement, compilation, abridgment or other form in which an existing work may be recast, transformed or adapted;

(c) "Distribute" means to reproduce, license, rent, lease, sell, broadcast, publicly display, transmit or otherwise distribute;

(d) "Open Game Content" means the game mechanic and includes the methods, procedures, processes and routines to the extent such content does not embody the Product Identity and is an enhancement over the prior art and any additional content clearly identified as Open Game Content by the Contributor, and means any work covered by this License, including translations and derivative works under copyright law, but specifically excludes Product Identity.

(e) "Product Identity" means product and product line names, logos and identifying marks including trade dress; artifacts; creatures characters; stories, storylines, plots, thematic elements, dialogue, incidents, language, artwork, symbols, designs, depictions, likenesses, formats, poses, concepts, themes and graphic, photographic and other visual or audio representations; names and descriptions of characters, spells, enchantments, personalities, teams, personas, likenesses and special abilities; places, locations, environments, creatures, equipment, magical or supernatural abilities or effects, logos, symbols, or graphic designs; and any other trademark or registered trademark clearly identified as Product identity by the owner of the Product Identity, and which specifically excludes the Open Game Content;

(f) "Trademark" means the logos, names, mark, sign, motto, designs that are used by a Contributor to identify itself or its products or the associated products contributed to the Open Game License by the Contributor

(g) "Use", "Used" or "Using" means to use, Distribute, copy, edit, format, modify, translate and otherwise create Derivative Material of Open Game Content.

(h) "You" or "Your" means the licensee in terms of this agreement.

The License: This License applies to any Open Game Content that contains a notice indicating that the Open Game Content may only be Used under and in terms of this License. You must affix such a notice to any Open Game Content that you Use. No terms may be added to or subtracted from this License except as described by the License itself. No other terms or conditions may be applied to any Open Game Content distributed using this License.

Offer and Acceptance: By Using the Open Game Content You indicate Your acceptance of the terms of this License.

Grant and Consideration: In consideration for agreeing to use this License, the Contributors grant You a perpetual, worldwide, royalty-free, non-exclusive license with the exact terms of this License to Use, the Open Game Content.

Representation of Authority to Contribute: If You are contributing original material as Open Game Content, You represent that Your Contributions are Your original creation and/or You have sufficient rights to grant the rights conveyed by this License.

Notice of License Copyright: You must update the COPYRIGHT NOTICE portion of this License to include the exact text of the COPYRIGHT NOTICE of any Open Game Content You are copying, modifying or distributing, and You must add the title, the copyright date, and the copyright holder's name to the COPYRIGHT NOTICE of any original Open Game Content you Distribute.

Use of Product Identity: You agree not to Use any Product Identity, including as an indication as to compatibility, except as expressly licensed in another, independent Agreement with the owner of each element of that Product Identity. You agree not to indicate compatibility or co-adaptability with any Trademark or Registered Trademark in conjunction with a work containing Open Game Content except as expressly licensed in another, independent Agreement with the owner of such Trademark or Registered Trademark. The use of any Product Identity in Open Game Content does not constitute a challenge to the ownership of that Product Identity. The owner of any Product Identity used in Open Game Content shall retain all rights, title and interest in and to that Product Identity.

Identification: If you distribute Open Game Content You must clearly indicate which portions of the work that you are distributing are Open Game Content.

Updating the License: Wizards or its designated Agents may publish updated versions of this License. You may use any authorized version of this License to copy, modify and distribute any Open Game Content originally distributed under any version of this License.

Copy of this License: You MUST include a copy of this License with every copy of the Open Game Content You Distribute.

Use of Contributor Credits: You may not market or advertise the Open Game Content using the name of any Contributor unless You have written permission from the Contributor to do so.

Inability to Comply: If it is impossible for You to comply with any of the terms of this License with respect to some or all of the Open Game Content due to statute, judicial order, or governmental regulation then You may not Use any Open Game Material so affected.

Termination: This License will terminate automatically if You fail to comply with all terms herein and fail to cure such breach within 30 days of becoming aware of the breach. All sublicenses shall survive the termination of this License.

Reformation: If any provision of this License is held to be unenforceable, such provision shall be reformed only to the extent necessary to make it enforceable.

COPYRIGHT NOTICE

Open Game License v1.0 Copyright 2000, Wizards of the Coast, Inc.

System Reference Document Copyright 2000-2003, Wizards of the Coast, Inc.; Authors Jonathan Tweet, Monte Cook, Skip Williams, Rich Baker, Andy Collins, David Noonan, Rich Redman, Bruce R. Cordell, John D. Rateliff, Thomas Reid, James Wyatt, based on original material by E. Gary Gygax and Dave Arneson.

© 2021, Limithron





Crowd on every inch of sail!

Weigh anchor, hoist the mains,
and set sail... rough seas lie head!

Crew up a nimble sloop and tack
into the wind. Load a Man of War
with enough cannons to scare ever
captain in these water. Wage all
out war with the largest fleet to
ever set sail. Capture a magical
ship with legendary abilities.

Do all this & more with *Limithron's
Guide to Naval Combat*, an easy-
to-use rules supplement for the
5th edition of the world's most
popular roleplaying game.



Limithron.com



ISBN 979-8-9871167-1-5



9 798987 116715 >

LMTHRN-NAV1